

Packaged Drinking Water and BIS Certification · Consumer Guide (Sample)

PACKAGED DRINKING WATER AND BIS

Packaged drinking water is one of the products for which BIS certification has been mandatory in India under a Quality Control Order. The applicable Indian Standard for packaged drinking water (other than packaged natural mineral water) is IS 14543. Packaged natural mineral water is covered by IS 13428. Manufacturers of packaged drinking water must obtain a BIS licence and bear the ISI mark before selling in India. Verify the latest requirement and scope on the official BIS source.

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WHAT IS IN THE STANDARD

The standard lays down requirements for hygiene of the source water, treatment such as filtration, reverse osmosis or disinfection as applicable, microbiological limits, chemical limits for parameters such as total dissolved solids and pesticide residues, packaging in food-grade containers, and testing per the prescribed methods. The manufacturer must operate a Scheme of Testing and Inspection with regular testing of each lot.

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WHAT THE CONSUMER SHOULD CHECK

1. The ISI mark on the bottle or pack together with the licence number in CM/L format. 2. Verify the licence on the BIS website or the BIS Care mobile application. 3. The manufacturing or batch date and the best before date. 4. An intact, tamper-evident seal; the bottle stored away from direct sunlight. 5. The declared type: packaged drinking water or natural mineral water; these are different standards. If a packaged water bottle does not carry the ISI mark and licence number, do not buy it and report it through the BIS Care app.

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FOOD PRODUCTS AND OTHER AUTHORITIES

Most food products in India are regulated by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) under the Food Safety and Standards Act. BIS certification applies to specific notified food products such as packaged drinking water, and BIS standards also exist for many food-contact materials and some processed foods. For a given food product, check the FSSAI licence number on the pack first, and the ISI mark where BIS certification applies. Certification for most foods other than notified items is voluntary.